

*Haligric Research Integration Series*

# **NAVAJO / DINE**

## **A COMPLETE DEEP DIVE**

*The People of the Fifth World -- Hozho, the Four Sacred Mountains, Changing Woman, Sandpainting,  
and the Blessing Way*

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*"Beauty before me, beauty behind me,  
beauty below me, beauty above me,  
beauty all around me.*

*I walk in beauty. It is finished in beauty."*

*-- The Hozho Prayer, from the Blessing Way ceremony*

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## **A Note on Dine Sacred Knowledge**

The Navajo Nation (Dine Bikeyah -- the Dine homeland) is a sovereign nation with its own protocols regarding sacred knowledge. This guide draws on the extensive ethnographic and collaborative scholarly record -- including Washington Matthews's foundational documentation of the Night Chant (conducted in the 1880s-1890s with Dine ceremonial practitioners' involvement), Charlotte Frisbie's collaborative work, the Dine Policy Institute's materials, and materials shared by Dine scholars and cultural institutions. The specific wording of ceremonial chants, certain sandpainting designs considered too sacred for reproduction, and specific ceremonial protocols maintained within the hataali (ceremonial practitioner) tradition are not included here. The level of description provided reflects what is documented in the public scholarly record.

## **Introduction -- The People of the Fifth World**

The Navajo Nation (Dine -- "the People," from the term Naabeehō, the Nation's own name in English) is the largest Indigenous nation in the United States by land area -- the Navajo Nation Reservation covers approximately 27,000 square miles of the Colorado Plateau in present-day Arizona, New Mexico, and Utah. The Dine people number approximately 173,000-200,000 enrolled members, making the Navajo Nation one of the most populous Indigenous nations in North America.

The Dine are a people whose identity is inseparable from a specific landscape: the Colorado Plateau's red sandstone mesas, the deep canyons (including Canyon de Chelly, where Dine have lived continuously for centuries), the vast open sky of the high desert, and the four sacred mountains that define the boundaries of the Dine homeland. The land is not a backdrop -- it is a participant in Dine sacred life. The central concept of Dine sacred life is Hozho -- usually translated as beauty, harmony, or balance, but encompassing all three simultaneously and more. The entire Dine ceremonial system -- hundreds of specific ceremonies, each with specific songs, sandpaintings, and protocols -- exists to restore Hozho when it has been disrupted.

## **The Dine -- Identity, Language, and Territory**

The Dine language (Navajo) belongs to the Athabaskan language family -- making the Dine linguistically related to the Apache peoples of the Southwest and to Athabaskan-speaking peoples of the Pacific Northwest and Canada. Navajo is one of the most widely spoken Indigenous languages in North America, with approximately 150,000-170,000 speakers. The Navajo Code Talkers of World War II -- Dine men who used their language as the basis of an unbreakable military code -- are among the most celebrated expressions of the language's specific character. The Dine were not always in the Southwest -- they are historically a late-arriving people who migrated from the north over centuries and established themselves in the Colorado Plateau area in the 15th-17th centuries, gradually developing the specific synthesis of their Athabaskan heritage with the traditions of the Pueblo peoples and other Southwestern cultures that constitutes the Dine sacred tradition as it is known today.

## **The Four Sacred Mountains -- The Dine Homeland**

The four sacred mountains define the boundaries of Dine Bikeyah -- the Dine homeland -- in all four directions. They are not merely geographical landmarks; they are sacred beings whose spiritual character sustains the Dine homeland's sacred integrity. East: Sisnaajihí (Blanca Peak, Colorado) -- the white mountain of the east, associated with dawn, white shell (yoogaii), and new beginnings. South: Tsoodzil (Mount Taylor, New Mexico) -- the turquoise mountain of the south, associated with midday, turquoise, and abundance. West:

Dook'o'ooslid (San Francisco Peaks, Arizona) -- the yellow mountain of the west, associated with sunset, abalone shell, and completion. North: Dibe Nitsaa (Hesperus Mountain, Colorado) -- the black mountain of the north, associated with darkness, jet black stone, and the deep teachings. The sacred bundle: when the Dine were created, Changing Woman filled a sacred mountain bundle with soil from each of the four sacred mountains. This bundle is used in specific ceremonies to connect participants to the four mountains' sacred power.

## **Hozho -- The Central Sacred Principle**

Hozho is the most important concept in the entire Dine sacred universe -- the condition of right relationship, harmony, balance, and beauty that is simultaneously the goal of all Dine ceremonial practice and the natural state of the sacred world when human beings are living properly within it. Hozho cannot be adequately translated by any single English word. When it is called beauty, the beauty referred to is not aesthetic preference but the specific quality of beauty that belongs to a world in right relationship -- the beauty of the healthy body, of the harmonious family, of the community at peace, of the land properly cared for. When it is called harmony, the harmony is not merely an absence of conflict but the active, sustained alignment of all things with their proper place in the sacred order.

Hochxo' is the condition opposing Hozho -- the state of disharmony, ugliness, sickness, and wrong relationship that Dine ceremonies are specifically designed to address. Hochxo' is not evil in a moral sense; it is the state of things being out of alignment with the sacred order. Illness, accident, drought, community conflict -- all are expressions of hochxo' at different scales. The causes of hochxo' include: violation of specific taboos (contact with the dead -- chindi -- is the most common), lightning strike, contact with enemies (particularly in warfare), and violation of protocols governing relationships with specific sacred beings. The entire Dine ceremonial system -- the hundreds of specific ceremonies (sings/chants) -- all have the restoration of Hozho as their primary purpose.

*HALIGRIC LENS: Hozho -- the Dine name for the sacred state of right relationship, balance, beauty, and harmony -- is the Dine articulation of what every tradition in the Haligrity library recognizes under its own name: Asha (Zoroastrian), Maat (Egyptian), Tao (Chinese), Dharma (Hindu/Buddhist), Ubuntu (Bantu). The Haligrity Tetralogy's alignment principle -- that genuine sacred practice requires the correspondence of Feeling, Thinking, Speaking, and Doing with the sacred order -- is the Haligrity formulation of Hozho. Alignment is Hozho. Hozho is alignment.*

## **The Holy People (Diyin Dine'e)**

The Diyin Dine'e (Holy People) are the sacred beings of the Dine universe -- beings who existed before humans, who created the conditions for human life, who established the ceremonial system through which humans can maintain Hozho, and who are invoked in every Dine ceremony. They are not gods in the Abrahamic sense -- they are not omnipotent or omniscient, and their power is specific rather than universal. The major Holy People include: Changing Woman (the most beloved and most widely honored); First Man and First Woman (who organized the world at the beginning); Spider Woman (teacher of weaving); the Sun (father of the Hero Twins, giver of light, and one of the most powerful Holy People); and the Yei (the specific sacred beings who appear in the Night Chant ceremony).

## **Changing Woman -- The Most Beloved Holy Person**

Changing Woman (Asdzaa Nadleehe) is the central Holy Person of the Dine sacred tradition -- the being who created the Dine clans from the skin of her own body, who received the Blessing Way ceremony from the Holy People and gave it to the Dine, and whose cycles of renewal (young girl in spring, mature woman in summer, elderly in fall, renewed in winter) embody the deepest truth of Hozho: that the sacred order is not static but continuously self-

renewing. Changing Woman lives at the western ocean on a floating island -- moving with the seasons in her own cycles of renewal. She is associated with the earth, with corn, with women's sacred cycles, and with the maintenance of life. The most direct expression of Changing Woman's continuing presence in Dine life is the Kinaalda -- the coming-of-age ceremony for young women at their first menstruation, which re-enacts Changing Woman's own first becoming.

## **The Hero Twins -- Monster Slayer and Born for Water**

The Hero Twins -- Monster Slayer (Naayee Neizghani) and Born for Water (Tobajishchini) -- are the sons of Changing Woman and the Sun, whose journey to find their father and receive weapons from him forms one of the most important narratives in the Dine sacred tradition. After the emergence into the present world, monsters (naayee) were ravaging the earth and threatening to destroy humanity. The Hero Twins traveled to the Sun's home, proved themselves as his sons through specific tests, and received specific weapons (lightning bolts and other sacred powers) from him. They then traveled through the world, defeating the monsters one by one and making the earth safe for human life. Monster Slayer and Born for Water are invoked in the specific ceremonies that address the disruptions caused by violence, warfare, and contact with enemies -- the Enemy Way ceremony being the most important.

## **Spider Woman and Sacred Weaving**

Spider Woman (Na'ashjei'ii Asdzaa) is the Holy Person who taught weaving to the Dine -- specifically, who instructed the first Dine women in the art of weaving on the loom that Spider Man (her husband) designed. The loom's structure is itself a cosmological map: the sky and earth cords of the warp are attached above and below; the sun rays that Spider Man used as the loom's frame are the warp sticks; the rock crystal and sheet lightning serve as heddles. The weaving process enacts the sacred cosmology with every motion of the shuttle. Navajo weaving is not merely art -- it is a sacred practice, and the specific patterns of traditional Navajo textiles carry specific sacred meanings that have been transmitted through the weaving tradition across generations. Spider Woman also played a crucial role in the Hero Twins' journey to find their father the Sun, providing specific guidance and specific protective objects.

## **The Creation Narrative -- The Emergence Through the Worlds**

The Dine creation narrative describes a journey of emergence -- the ancestors' movement through a series of underworlds (commonly four or five) to arrive at the present world (the Glittering World). Each world was left when its conditions became impossible -- when beings ran out of space, or when their conduct violated the sacred order. The First World (Black World): the beginning, inhabited by beings not yet fully formed humans. The Second World (Blue-Green World): larger, but the people are driven out by conflict with beings already inhabiting the world. The Third World (Yellow World): where significant events of the pre-human story occur -- where the first monsters arose, where the Great Flood eventually forces the emergence upward. The Fourth World (White World): increasingly fully formed pre-human beings. The Fifth World (Glittering World -- the present world): prepared for human habitation by the Holy People -- the four sacred mountains placed at the four directions, the sacred plants established, the sun and moon set in motion.

## **The Clan System -- Identity, Kinship, and Sacred Obligation**

The Dine clan system is one of the most complete available expressions of the principle that individual identity is not primary -- the individual's place within a web of sacred relationships is primary. Every Dine person is born into their mother's clan (their primary

clan) and born for their father's clan (their secondary clan). In a formal introduction, a Dine person states: Nishli (I am of the clan): their mother's clan; Bashishchin (I was born for): their father's clan; Dashicheii (my maternal grandfather's clan); and Dashinali (my paternal grandfather's clan). The four-clan identification places every person within a specific set of relationships and a specific set of obligations -- clans create kinship ties that extend across the entire Dine Nation, and clan members are understood as relatives even if they have never met. Marriage within the same clan is prohibited. The clan system is simultaneously a genealogical record, a kinship map, and a sacred framework that organizes the entire social world.

## **The Four Sacred Plants and Pollen**

The four sacred plants of the Dine are corn, beans, squash, and tobacco -- the agricultural complex that the Holy People gave to the Dine as the basis of their material life. Each plant has its specific sacred associations and its specific ceremonial uses. Corn pollen (tadidiin) is the most sacred Dine offering substance -- the golden pollen of the corn used to mark the body in ceremony, to make offerings, to bless objects and spaces, and to close prayers. Corn pollen is the material form of Hozho made portable: it carries the specific beauty of the corn's sacred character and the specific blessing power of Changing Woman's gift. Every Dine ceremony involves corn pollen at some point. Many Dine people carry a small pouch of corn pollen as a daily sacred object, offering a pinch to the four directions in morning prayer.

## **The Blessing Way (Hozhooji) -- The Foundation Ceremony, Step-by-Step**

The Blessing Way (Hozhooji -- the walking in beauty way) is the most fundamental and most widely performed ceremony in the Dine ceremonial system -- conducted to attract Hozho, to strengthen a person's relationship with the Holy People, and to bless major life transitions (pregnancy, childbirth, military service, healing, marriage). Changing Woman herself established the Blessing Way and gave it to the Dine. Unlike the Enemy Way (which addresses the disruption of Hozho) or the Night Chant (which addresses specific illnesses), the Blessing Way is primarily preventive and strengthening. Duration: two nights and two days.

**Step 1 -- The Sweat and Emetic:** Purification -- the person sung over takes an herbal emetic to cleanse internally and undergoes a sweat bath.

**Step 2 -- The Sacred Bath:** The person's hair is washed in yucca suds -- marking the boundary between ordinary state and the sacred state being entered.

**Step 3 -- Dressing in Sacred Garments:** The person is dressed in garments associated with the Holy People -- white shell beads, turquoise, clothing identifying them with the sacred beings whose blessing is sought.

**Step 4 -- The Pollen Application:** Corn pollen is applied to the soles of the feet, palms, crown of the head, and lips -- aligning the person's body with the sacred directions and with the Holy People's blessing.

**Step 5 -- Night One -- The Chanting:** The hataali begins specific chants of the Blessing Way, continuing for hours through the first night. Songs recount the story of Changing Woman, the Hero Twins' journey, the establishment of the sacred mountains.

**Step 6 -- The Prayer Sticks:** Sacred prayer sticks (kethawns) are made and placed in specific directions as material offerings to the Holy People.

**Step 7 -- The Dawn Songs:** At dawn of the second morning, the Dawn Songs greet the sun's return and call the Hozho of the new day into the person's life.

**Step 8 -- The Closing Prayer:** Beauty before me, beauty behind me, beauty below me, beauty above me, beauty all around me, I walk in beauty -- the most widely known words in the entire Dine ceremonial tradition.

**Step 9 -- The Feast:** A communal feast follows -- the gathered community sharing food as the physical expression of the Hozho that has been restored or strengthened.

## **The Enemy Way (Anaa'ji) -- Restoring Hozho After Contact with Enemies**

The Enemy Way is the Dine ceremony specifically designed to restore Hozho that has been disrupted by contact with enemies, by exposure to death in battle, or by the specific spiritual contamination that warfare produces. The ceremony involves the hataali, the patient, and two communities -- the patient's home community and a community from a different location who serves as the "stick receiver" in the ceremony's exchange structure. The Enemy Way is typically conducted over three nights, during which the specific songs, prayers, and sandpaintings that address the spiritual disruption of enemy contact are deployed. In the contemporary Navajo Nation, the Enemy Way is frequently conducted for veterans returning from military service -- acknowledging that the exposure to killing and to the deaths of comrades produces the specific form of spiritual disruption that this ceremony was designed to address.

## **The Night Chant -- Sequence and Sacred Structure**

The Night Chant (Yeibitchai or T'eeji) is a nine-night ceremony -- one of the most elaborate and most sacred of all Dine ceremonial forms -- conducted to treat specific conditions (primarily those associated with deafness, blindness, and paralysis in the tradition's specific understanding) and to provide a major Hozho renewal for the patient and their community. The Night Chant belongs to the category of Holyway ceremonies -- the ceremonies that work by attracting the positive sacred forces. The ceremony's ninth and final night is the only night that outside observers have historically been permitted to attend; the eight preceding nights are conducted within the restricted ceremonial structure. The Yei (Holy People in their masked form) appear during the Night Chant, represented by masked performers whose specific appearances, specific dances, and specific vocalizations (a specific falsetto cry) embody the specific Holy People being invoked. Healing occurs through the patient's contact with the sandpaintings and through the sustained ceremonial invocation of Hozho across nine nights.

## **Sandpainting -- Sacred Medicine Made Visible, Step-by-Step**

The Dine sandpainting (iikaa -- place where the gods come and go) is one of the most visually extraordinary and most spiritually sophisticated sacred art forms in any tradition -- the creation of a specific geometric design using colored sands, pollens, cornmeal, and charcoal on a specially prepared sand base, for the specific purpose of inviting the Holy People to be present in the ceremony and to transmit their healing power to the person sung over. The sandpainting is not art. It is medicine. Its purpose is not to be beautiful (though it is beautiful -- it embodies the beauty of Hozho) but to be effective -- to create the specific sacred image that invites the specific Holy People whose presence is required. When its purpose is accomplished, it is dismantled.

**Step 1 -- The Preparation of the Space:** A specific area is cleared and leveled. The space is oriented according to the specific ceremony's directional requirements.

**Step 2 -- The Gathering of Materials:** The hataali and assistants gather the specific colored materials required -- crushed minerals of specific colors, pollen, cornmeal, and charcoal.

**Step 3 -- Making From the Center:** The sandpainting is made from the center outward -- establishing the central sacred figure first and building the design outward in all four directions.

**Step 4 -- The Precision of the Design:** Each sandpainting design is a specific, memorized composition -- not improvised. The hataali has learned each design through years of apprenticeship, and any significant error must be corrected before the ceremony can proceed.

**Step 5 -- The Invitation:** When complete, a specific song or prayer invites the Holy People represented in the design to be present -- to inhabit the sacred image.

**Step 6 -- The Person Sung Over Enters:** The person is brought to the sandpainting and seated in its center. The physical contact between the person's body and the sandpainting image is the moment of healing transmission.

**Step 7 -- The Transfer Touches:** The hataali takes colored sands from specific parts of the sandpainting figure and applies them to the corresponding parts of the person's body.

**Step 8 -- The Dissolution:** After the ceremony is complete, the sandpainting is deliberately destroyed -- the sands gathered from the outside inward and removed from the ceremonial space. The image has done its work.

## **The Sweat Lodge (Tacheeh) -- Dine Practice, Step-by-Step**

**Step 1 -- Construction:** The sweat lodge is built as a dome frame of bent willows, covered with blankets or canvas. The door faces east. The central pit is prepared for the hot stones.

**Step 2 -- The Fire and Stones:** A fire is kindled outside and east of the lodge, and stones are heated in it. The Dine sweat lodge stones are greeted as grandfathers -- acknowledged as ancient beings of earth.

**Step 3 -- Smudging:** Before entering, participants may be smudged with specific Dine sacred plants -- sage or cedar.

**Step 4 -- Entry with Prayer:** Participants enter clockwise, moving to their designated positions. Each person offers a brief prayer acknowledging the purpose.

**Step 5 -- The Stones Enter:** Hot stones are brought in and placed in the central pit using deer antlers. Each stone is greeted and pollen may be offered on it.

**Step 6 -- The Four Rounds:** Water is poured on the stones in four rounds -- each dedicated to one of the four sacred directions. Between rounds, the door is opened.

**Step 7 -- The Pollen Blessing:** Corn pollen is often offered to the stones or sprinkled in the four directions during the ceremony.

**Step 8 -- Closing Prayer:** The ceremony closes with the Hozho prayer: Beauty before me, beauty behind me...

## **The Beauty Way Walks -- Hozho in Daily Life**

The most accessible expression of Hozho in daily Dine life is the practice of walking in beauty -- the deliberate orientation of one's attention, one's speech, one's movement, and one's relationship with the surrounding world toward right relationship. The Beauty Way Walk is both a ceremony and a daily practice: walking through the landscape with conscious attention to the sacredness of everything one encounters, addressing the specific sacred presences of the land, using the Hozho Prayer as a framework for the day's beginning, and maintaining the specific quality of awareness that keeps the practitioner within the condition of Hozho rather than sliding into hochxo'. The specific daily practices of a traditional Dine practitioner include: the morning prayer at dawn facing east; the offering of corn pollen to



the four directions; the specific care for the sacred objects of the household; and the specific protocols governing relationships with specific animals, plants, and sacred places.

## **The Kinaalda -- Girl's Coming of Age Ceremony, Complete Step-by-Step**

The Kinaalda is the Dine coming-of-age ceremony for young women at their first menstruation -- one of the most important lifecycle ceremonies in the tradition and the ceremony that most directly re-enacts Changing Woman's own first becoming. At the moment of first menstruation, a young woman becomes Changing Woman -- not metaphorically but in a direct sacred sense. Duration: four days and four nights.

**Step 1 -- Announcement:** When a girl experiences her first menstruation, the family prepares. An experienced woman elder is asked to guide the girl through the ceremony.

**Step 2 -- The Hair Combing and Dressing:** The girl's hair is washed in yucca suds and combed smooth. She is dressed in the full traditional dress of Dine womanhood -- velveteen blouse, tiered skirt, turquoise and shell jewelry.

**Step 3 -- The First Run (Dawn of Day One):** At dawn of the first morning, the girl runs east, toward the rising sun. She runs as far as she can and returns -- her running embodies the vigor of Changing Woman's youth, and the distance she runs corresponds to the length and happiness of her life.

**Step 4 -- Running on Subsequent Days:** The girl runs at dawn on each of the four mornings -- each run potentially longer than the last.

**Step 5 -- The Molding:** The girl's body is formally molded by the elder woman guiding her -- the elder's hands pressing over the girl's body, shaping her into her womanhood.

**Step 6 -- The Grinding:** The girl grinds corn -- the sustained labor demonstrating her capacity for the work that women's traditional life requires.

**Step 7 -- The Alkaan (Sacred Cake):** The girl makes a large cornmeal cake baked in an earth oven -- made with specific songs and specific prayer. The cake is the most sacred element of the Kinaalda.

**Step 8 -- The Night of Singing:** On the last night, the entire community gathers and sings through the night -- the specific songs of the Blessing Way and of Changing Woman.

**Step 9 -- The Dawn Completion:** At the final dawn, the girl runs one last time -- her most significant run toward the fully risen sun. She is now Changing Woman, running into her life.

**Step 10 -- The Feast and Distribution:** The sacred cake is cut and distributed to every person present. The girl who will sustain the people begins by literally feeding them.

## **Death and Mourning -- The Chindi**

In the Dine understanding, when a person dies, the good elements of their spirit (their hozho) join the sacred world, while the disharmonious elements remain near the body and the place of death as the chindi (ghost or dangerous spirit). The chindi is the reason for specific death-related taboos: the body should ideally be removed from a structure through a hole in the wall rather than the door (to prevent the chindi from following the living path out), ideally buried quickly and away from human habitation, and the name of the deceased is traditionally not spoken (to avoid summoning the chindi). Structures where people have died have traditionally been abandoned. The specific mourning protocols vary by community and have changed significantly over generations of contact with Anglo-American culture. Contemporary Dine people navigate between traditional protocols and contemporary medical and funeral practices in various ways, and the specific decisions are individual and community-specific.

## **The Hataali -- Sacred Practitioners**

The hataali (singer or chanter) is the Dine ceremonial practitioner -- the person trained in one or more specific ceremonies who conducts those ceremonies for patients and communities. The hataali's training is one of the most demanding in any sacred tradition -- learning a single ceremony may take years of apprenticeship, and a hataali who knows multiple major ceremonies has spent decades in training. The knowledge required is not merely theoretical but performative: the hataali must be able to sing hundreds of songs in the correct order, construct complex sandpaintings from memory, and manage the complex ceremonial logistics of multi-day ceremonies for patients and their extended families. The hataali's relationship with their teacher is one of the most sacred relationships in Dine culture -- the transmission of ceremonial knowledge is the transmission of the tradition itself.

A significant and ongoing concern: the number of hataali who know complete major ceremonies has been declining. The longest and most complex ceremonies (the Night Chant, the Mountain Chant, the Enemy Way) require such extensive training that relatively few hataali have maintained complete knowledge of them. The Navajo Nation and various cultural preservation organizations are documenting ceremonial knowledge with the cooperation of willing hataali, and training programs are attempting to address the knowledge transmission challenge.

## **Contemporary Dine -- Water Rights and Sovereignty**

The Navajo Nation spans 27,000 square miles across Arizona, New Mexico, and Utah -- a land base larger than 10 U.S. states. The Dine population of approximately 400,000 enrolled members makes the Navajo Nation one of the largest Indigenous nations in the country. Yet over 30% of Navajos on the reservation do not have running water in their homes -- traveling great distances to collect water while the average American uses 80-100 gallons of water per day for household needs. The water crisis is simultaneously a public health crisis, a political crisis, and a sacred crisis: in a tradition where Hozho is the central principle, a community without reliable water access cannot maintain the specific daily practices that maintain Hozho.

In May 2024, the 25th Navajo Nation Council unanimously approved the Northeastern Arizona Indian Water Rights Settlement Agreement -- a historic achievement after more than 100 years of water rights disputes. The Northeastern Arizona Indian Water Rights Settlement Act of 2025 (S.953/H.R.2025) -- introduced to Congress in March 2025 by Senators Kelly and Gallego -- would ratify this agreement, which authorizes \$5.1 billion to acquire, build, and maintain essential water development and delivery projects, including the iina ba - paa tuwaqat'si pipeline (formerly the Western Navajo Pipeline). The settlement is widely described as the largest Indian water rights settlement in U.S. history. The Navajo Nation Council Speaker Crystalyne Curley stated: "Water is life, and as Dine, we don't place a price tag on life... tens of thousands of Navajo people in Arizona do not have water in their homes. The infrastructure funded under the bill secures the necessary water supply that will serve our communities and our future generations."

## **The Haligrity Lens -- Hozho, Pollen, and the Sandpainting**

The Dine tradition offers Haligrity gifts of extraordinary philosophical depth and practical applicability: Hozho as the most complete and most philosophically precise articulation of the alignment principle that the Haligrity Tetralogy embodies; corn pollen as the most universally applicable sacred offering in any tradition in this library; and the sandpainting as the most complete available ancient model of the use of sacred visual form as a healing technology.

Hozho and the Haligric Tetralty: the practitioner whose Feeling, Thinking, Speaking, and Doing are in genuine correspondence with each other and with the sacred order is walking in Hozho. The practitioner whose four dimensions are misaligned is living in hochxo'. The entire Haligric practice is a technology for walking in beauty. The Hozho Prayer -- Beauty before me, beauty behind me, beauty below me, beauty above me, beauty all around me, I walk in beauty. It is finished in beauty. -- is one of the most complete and most beautiful ceremonial closing prayers in any tradition. It maps Hozho onto the six directions and declares both the present condition and the intention of the practitioner walking within it. The sandpainting takes hours to make and is destroyed in minutes. Its purpose is not preservation; its purpose is medicine. The healing is complete when the image has done its work and the sands are returned to the earth.

The four sacred mountains stand where they have always stood. Changing Woman renews herself with each season. The hataali sings through the night and the person sung over receives the Holy People's blessing through the colored sands. At dawn, the girl runs toward the sun and becomes, in that moment, Changing Woman -- the one who renews. Hozho is not a belief. It is a condition maintained through practice, through ceremony, through the specific technologies of song and sand and pollen and running. Hozhoogo naashaa doo. Grand Rising.